

AMD goes all out

AMD continued its momentum in the CPU and GPU space while making a few key announcements. For starters, they announced the 64-core AMD Ryzen Threadripper 3990X HEDT CPU. This was followed by the Ryzen 4000 mobile CPU announcement which will use their 7nm node and the top SKU will have 8-cores and 16-threads. AMD also shared preliminary benchmarks which show the Ryzen 7 4800U processor being ahead of the Intel Core i7-1065G7 (Ice Lake) in multi-threaded, graphics and even in



single-threaded performance. Then followed the Radeon RX 5600 XT mid-range graphics card announcement. You can read the review in this month's Bazaar section. One of the slides in AMD's presentation also had a

render of Microsoft's upcoming Xbox Series X console which revealed the I/O options the console is expected to have. This was later retracted as AMD said that the render wasn't sourced from Microsoft. Lastly, AMD announced that it was rebranding their FreeSync monitor adaptive sync technology. Instead of FreeSync and FreeSync 2 HDR classification, the monitors will now be classified as FreeSync(old FreeSync), FreeSync Premium(new tier) and FreeSync Premium Pro(old FreeSync 2 HDR). The new tier is for displays that guarantee at least 120 Hz refresh rate at Full HD resolution with low frame-rate compensation (LFC) technology.



Samsung's Project NEON

Samsung's project NEON had piqued our curiosity much before CES 2020 came around. It's was being hailed as the first "Artificial Human", so that naturally had us entranced. Built by CORE R3, a company that emerged from STAR Labs, NEON is about creating virtual human beings whose AI models have been extensively trained to look, behave and interact like real humans.

The NEON video chatbots can analyse your emotions and empathise with you in the same manner as a fellow human being can. The underlying platform is optimised to have very low latency which makes the interaction seem spontaneous as the NEON bots can interact with you in near real time.

Samsung had several NEON humans on display from different walks of life showcasing the versatility of the platform. These NEONs are currently limited to the virtual world but the day wouldn't be far when it's mated with a lifelike robot.

Intel's bendy computer

While bendy smartphones were huge at last year's MWC, this year saw the concept enter the PC space as Lenovo and Intel, both showcased their devices. Lenovo's ThinkPad X1 Fold is a commercial unit that's expected to go on sale later this year but Intel's device is a concept piece which they're calling "Horseshoe Bend". The prototype is quite large with a 17.3-inch screen configured in a 4:3 aspect ratio and is very much like a traditional laptop once opened up. It even has a kick-stand like the Microsoft Surface book to prop it up and prevent it

from keeling over while interacting with the top side of the bend.

Intel tends to produce prototypes around its silicon products to showcase their true potential and that was the case here as the Horseshoe Bend. Intel



has some software demos at their open house to showcase how the UI can be altered to adapt to bendy touchscreen displays. Horseshoe Bend is powered by Intel's upcoming 10nm Tiger Lake processors which are slated to ship towards the latter half of this year. The supposed power savings of Tiger Lake allows devices to be built thinner and given the low TDP, the need for active cooling mechanisms is done away with. Intel did not completely close the prototype in front of journalists but they did open it up all the way to form a flat slate. Intel mentioned that they might use Windows 10X for similar form factor devices when they do start shipping partner devices such as the Lenovo Thinkpad X1 Fold, later this year.